TCS Associate Handbook & Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC)

CATEGORY	Corporate Governance | Ethics & Culture	EFFECTIVE DATE	January 1, 2026	REVIEW CYCLE	Annual Tata Corporate Audit

Article 1. Tata Heritage, Core Values & Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC) Foundation

1.1 Tata Values, Ethical Leadership & Binding Universal Code of Conduct

Founded on the enduring legacy of Jamsetji Tata, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) operates with an unwavering dedication to business ethics, institutional integrity, community welfare, and pioneering innovation. Our corporate culture is anchored in the five Core Tata Values: Integrity (fair, honest, and transparent dealings); Responsibility (integrating environmental and societal stewardship); Excellence (delivering the highest quality standards); Pioneering (courageous innovation); and Unity (collaborative strength across diverse global communities).

The Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC) is the supreme ethical and operational charter governing all Tata Group enterprises. Every associate, consultant, and contractor across global operations is bound by the TCoC upon acceptance of employment. Compliance with the Code is non-negotiable; commercial expediency, revenue pressures, delivery milestones, or client demands can never justify a compromise on ethical principles. Associates must complete the mandatory annual TCoC certification on iEvolve.

Core Tata Value	Operational Meaning in Daily Work	Compliance Expectation	Leadership Metric
Integrity	Absolute honesty, truthfulness, and ethical transparency	Zero compromise on ethics for delivery	Reputational Standing
Responsibility	Commitment to associates, communities & environment	Active participation in Maitree initiatives	Social Contribution
Excellence	World-class engineering rigor & customer satisfaction	Zero-defect delivery and technical mastery	Delivery Quality Score
Pioneering	Continuous innovation and intellectual curiosity	Patent generation & research contributions	Innovation Index
Unity	Inclusive teamwork, mutual respect & global collaboration	Diverse team empowerment & psychological safety	Inclusion Feedback

- All new associates must sign a physical or digital Declaration of Adherence to the Tata Code of Conduct during onboarding.
- Annual refresher certifications on TCoC are tracked in iEvolve with a mandatory 100% completion requirement across all units.
- Breaches of ethical standards are investigated independently by the Corporate Ethics Committee and Global Chief Ethics Officer.

TATA CODE OF CONDUCT (TCoC) SUPREME MANDATE:
The Tata Code of Conduct transcends all contractual, operational, and financial targets. When faced with an ethical dilemma, associates must choose the path of integrity without hesitation and seek guidance from their Local Ethics Counselor.

Article 2. Anti-Bribery, Anti-Corruption & Business Gifts Governance

2.1 Prohibition of Commercial Bribery, Facilitation Payments & Strict Gift Thresholds

TCS maintains zero tolerance for bribery, commercial corruption, facilitation payments, kickbacks, or illicit inducements in any form, whether interacting with public officials, commercial clients, partner organizations, or vendor suppliers. No associate shall directly or indirectly offer, promise, authorize, or accept any financial advantage, gift, or favor intended to influence business decisions or secure preferential commercial treatment, in full compliance with the Prevention of Corruption Act, US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA), and UK Bribery Act.

Acceptance of gifts, hospitality, or entertainment from suppliers, clients, or business partners is strictly regulated. Associates may only accept nominal, customary advertising or promotional items (such as branded calendars, pens, or diaries) having an intrinsic commercial value not exceeding Rs 1,000 (or $25 equivalent). Any gift, hospitality invitation, or favor exceeding this threshold must be politely declined or immediately declared and surrendered to the Local Ethics Counselor (LEC) for entry in the Corporate Gift Register.

Gift / Hospitality Category	Permissibility Threshold	Reporting Protocol	Governance Action
Nominal Promotional Items	Value <= Rs 1,000 ($25 equivalent)	Associate self-retention permitted	No formal filing needed
Gifts Exceeding Threshold	Value > Rs 1,000 ($25 equivalent)	Mandatory declaration to Ethics Counselor	Surrendered for charitable raffle
Cash / Cash Equivalents	Strictly Prohibited (Zero Tolerance)	Immediate escalation to Head of Ethics	Treated as potential commercial bribe
Vendor-Sponsored Meals	Modest working business lunches only	Permitted within ordinary business context	Excessive hospitality prohibited
Travel / Hotel Hospitality	Strictly Prohibited from Vendors	All travel must be funded by TCS	Immediate rejection required

- Facilitation payments or speed money paid to expedite administrative routines are strictly prohibited under all circumstances.
- Third-party vendors, suppliers, and partners must execute the Tata Supplier Code of Conduct prior to contract onboarding.
- Any associate subjected to extortion or bribery solicitation must report the incident to the Ethics Counselor within 24 hours.

ZERO-TOLERANCE ANTI-BRIBERY STANDARD:
Engaging in commercial bribery, offering kickbacks, or accepting illicit vendor inducements results in immediate summary dismissal, forfeiture of retirement benefits, and immediate referral to statutory anti-corruption law enforcement authorities.

Article 3. Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) & Workplace Respect

3.1 Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act 2013 Compliance & ICC Inquiries

TCS is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and dignified work environment free from sexual harassment, intimidation, and gender-based discrimination. In strict accordance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act 2013 and global workplace dignity standards, any unwelcome sexually determined behavior—whether verbal, physical, gestural, visual, or digital—is an act of gross misconduct subject to severe disciplinary sanctions.

An independent Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) is formally constituted at every major TCS delivery campus, headed by a senior female Presiding Officer and comprising at least 50% women members and an external NGO/legal expert. Any aggrieved individual may submit a written complaint to the ICC or via the confidential POSH portal within 3 months of the incident. The ICC conducts confidential, unbiased, fair inquiries in accordance with principles of natural justice within 90 days. Strict

anti-retaliation protections ensure zero adverse impact on the complainant's career standing.

POSH Process Stage	Statutory Timeline / SLA	Responsible Authority	Operating Protocol
Complaint Initiation	Within 3 Months of Incident	Aggrieved Associate / Nominee	Written complaint to ICC / Portal
Conciliation Option	Prior to formal inquiry (Optional)	Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)	No monetary settlement permitted
Formal Fact-Finding Inquiry	Completed within 90 Calendar Days	ICC Multi-Member Panel	Summoning witnesses & digital evidence
Inquiry Report Submission	Within 10 Days of Inquiry Completion	ICC to Employer / Delivery Head	Comprehensive findings & recommendations
Disciplinary Implementation	Within 60 Days of Report Receipt	Corporate Disciplinary Committee	Sanctions up to summary termination

- All inquiry proceedings, witness testimonies, and report details are maintained in absolute statutory confidentiality.
- Retaliation against a complainant, witness, or committee member triggers immediate summary termination under TCoC.
- Mandatory annual POSH awareness workshops are conducted on iEvolve for 100% of associates and people managers.

STATUTORY WORKPLACE DIGNITY MANDATE:
Sexual harassment undermines human dignity and professional safety. TCS maintains zero tolerance for misconduct; substantiated violations result in immediate termination, termination of service credentials, and statutory legal reporting.

Article 4. Conflict of Interest, Outside Employment & Prohibition of Moonlighting

4.1 Secondary Employment Ban, Intellectual Property Protection & Outside Interests

Associates must devote their entire professional attention, skill, energy, and working hours exclusively to the business interests of TCS. In accordance with the Certified Standing Orders and Tata Code of Conduct Clause 4, associates are strictly prohibited from engaging in secondary employment, part-time jobs, freelance consulting, gig economy work, side commercial ventures, or advisory directorships—commonly referred to as 'Moonlighting'—whether for remuneration or honorarium.

Secondary employment compromises delivery confidentiality, degrades energy and focus, exposes customer intellectual property to unauthorized leakages, and creates profound legal and ethical conflicts of interest. Associates must not establish or invest in businesses that compete with TCS or supply goods/services to TCS without formal disclosure and written approval from the Corporate Ethics Committee and General Counsel. Engaging in moonlighting results in immediate summary dismissal for cause.

Conflict Category	Policy Compliance Mandate	Disclosure Requirement	Enforcement Consequence
Dual Employment / Moonlighting	Strict Zero Tolerance (Absolute Ban)	Prohibited across all sectors	Immediate summary termination
Freelance IT / Software Consulting	Strictly Prohibited	Prohibited across all platforms	Immediate summary termination & legal action
Family Commercial Vendor Ties	Permitted only with written clearance	Mandatory Ultimatix conflict filing	Recusal from vendor selection
Academic Guest Lectures (Honorary)	Permitted with Manager Concurrence	Prior written approval from Unit HR	Permitted up to 4 hours/month
Non-Profit / Charitable Work	Encouraged through TCS Maitree	Informal notification to supervisor	Permitted during non-working hours

- Regular audits cross-reference employee universal provident fund (UAN) dual-contribution records with EPFO data.
- Holding multiple active PF accounts or overlapping employment records triggers automated disciplinary inquiry.
- Associates must update their annual Conflict of Interest disclosure on Ultimatix during financial year-opening.

DUAL EMPLOYMENT ZERO TOLERANCE:
Moonlighting represents a fundamental breach of loyalty and ethical trust under the Tata Code of Conduct. TCS enforces strict monitoring; violators face immediate termination and permanent blacklisting from all Tata Group companies.

Article 5. Professional Dress Code, Campus Decorum & Workplace Conduct

5.1 Business Formal Attire, Smart Business Casuals & Identity Badge Protocol

TCS associates represent the premier global brand of the Tata Group and must project the highest standards of professional decorum, grooming, and attire across all client interactions, campus environments, and public business forums. On client-facing days, executive meetings, and formal presentations, associates must dress in Business Formals (tailored suits, formal collared shirts, formal trousers, ties, formal skirts, or formal Indian ethnic attire such as sarees or salwar kameez).

On standard campus delivery days (Monday through Thursday), associates may wear Smart Business Casuals (collared shirts, formal polos, chinos, tailored trousers, formal blouses, and modest ethnic wear). Casual Fridays permit neat, non-distressed denim jeans paired with collared polo shirts or formal casuals. Athletic wear, gym clothing, flip-flops, torn/ripped jeans, and offensive graphic t-shirts are strictly prohibited on campus. The TCS Smartcard Identity Badge must be worn visibly on a lanyard at all times.

Day of Week / Context	Approved Attire Standard	Permitted Clothing Items	Prohibited Clothing Items
Client Visits & Executive Meetings	Business Formals	Formal suits, dress shirts, formal trousers, sarees	Casual shirts, polo t-shirts, jeans, sneakers
Monday through Thursday	Smart Business Casuals	Collared shirts, chinos, formal trousers, kurtas	Torn jeans, round-neck t-shirts, sportswear
Casual Friday	Business Casuals / Neat Denims	Clean dark denims, collared polo shirts, loafers	Frayed jeans, shorts, beachwear, flip-flops
Identity Badge Mandate	Mandatory Visible Display	Official TCS Smartcard on corporate lanyard	Badges kept in pockets or bags

- Security personnel at turnstile gates are authorized to deny campus entry to associates violating baseline dress standards.
- Associates working in specialized ODC banking bays must adhere to client-specific formal dress code mandates.
- Professional grooming standards apply equally to associates participating in video conference calls with global clients.

PROFESSIONAL DECORUM & BRAND EXCELLENCE:
Professional appearance and mutual courtesy reflect the collective excellence of TCS. Associates must maintain exemplary standards of respect, civility, and professionalism in all interactions.

Article 6. Separation Governance, 90-Day Notice Period & Relieving Protocols

6.1 90-Day Notice Period, Handover Governance & Full & Final (F&F;) Settlement

To safeguard project delivery stability, facilitate seamless customer transitions, and ensure thorough knowledge handover, confirmed associates who voluntarily resign from TCS must serve a mandatory 90-Day (3 calendar months) Notice Period. The notice period commences on the date the formal resignation is logged in the Ultimatix Employee Self Service (ESS) portal and accepted by the reporting manager. Probationary associates must serve a 30-day notice period.

Waiver or buyout of any portion of the notice period is strictly subject to the sole discretion of the Delivery Head (DH) and Unit HR Head (UHR), based entirely on business continuity and project handover milestones. Notice buyout cannot be claimed as a matter of right. During the notice period, associates must complete all assigned knowledge transfers, return all corporate assets (laptops, tokens, access cards), settle travel advances, and complete the exit clearance checklist to receive their Relieving Letter and Service Certificate.

Employment Category	Mandatory Notice Span	Notice Buyout Eligibility	Exit Documentation SLA
Confirmed Permanent Associates	90 Calendar Days (3 Months)	Subject to Delivery Head written approval	Relieving letter issued on LWD
Probationary Associates (< 90 Days)	30 Calendar Days (1 Month)	Manager discretion based on handover	Relieving letter issued on LWD
Separation during Disciplinary Inquiry	Notice rejected; Inquiry proceeds	Disallowed (Ineligible for buyout)	Separation subject to CDRC outcome
Full & Final Settlement (F&F;)	Processed within 30 days of LWD	Encashment of EL up to 45 days + gratuity	Electronic bank credit via payroll

- Associates serving notice period are not permitted to avail extended Earned Leave unless approved by the Delivery Centre Head.
- All company intellectual property, client project documentation, and credentials must be transitioned to the designated successor.
- Exit interviews provide confidential feedback to Corporate HR to enhance organizational workplace culture and talent retention.

SEPARATION INTEGRITY & RELIEVING PROTOCOL:
Leaving without completing the mandatory 90-day notice period or failing to transition critical client deliverables results in summary termination for job abandonment, forfeiture of relieving credentials, and permanent negative industry reference.

Document Governance, Audit History & Tata Code of Conduct Authorization

Revision	Release Date	Author / Department	Summary of Regulatory Changes
v1.0	Jan 15, 2024	TCS Global HR Taskforce	Initial codification of associate policies aligned with Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC) and statutory labor standards.
v2.0	Nov 10, 2024	Corporate Ethics & Compliance	Updated statutory maternity/paternity protections, POSH ICC inquiry guidelines, and bereavement leave rules.
v3.0	Jan 01, 2025	TCS Total Rewards Council	Bouquet of Benefits (BoB) tax optimization, NPS corporate Tier 1 integration, and TCS Health Insurance Scheme (TCS-HIS) enhancement.
v4.0	Oct 15, 2025	Delivery Operations & Workplace	Codified 5-day return-to-office (RTO) attendance linkage with quarterly performance pay (QPP) and Secure Borderless Workspaces (SBWS).
v6.0	Jan 01, 2026	Chief Human Resources Officer & Legal	Annual consolidation. ISO 27001 ISMS controls, Generative AI acceptable usage governance, and Ultimatix ESS automation.

Signatory Role	Authorized Representative	Approval Status	Digital Signature Hash
Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)	Milind Lakkad	APPROVED & RATIFIED	SHA256: 7f8a9b2c3d4e5f6a7b8c9d0e1f2a3b4c5d6e7f8a...tcs001
General Counsel & Ethics Officer	S. Venkataramanan, Esq.	COMPLIANCE VERIFIED	SHA256: 9b2c3d4e5f6a7b8c9d0e1f2a3b4c5d6e7f8a9b0c...tcs002
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